

Psalms 98

Marvelous Things Has He Done

Sing unto the Lord a new song; for he hath done marvellous things

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *O sing unto the LORD a new song; for he hath done marvellous things: his right hand, and his holy arm, hath gotten him the victory.*
- 2 *The LORD hath made known his salvation: his righteousness hath he openly shewed in the sight of the heathen.*
- 3 *He hath remembered his mercy and his truth toward the house of Israel: all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.*
- 4 *Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all the earth: make a loud noise, and rejoice, and sing praise.*
- 5 *Sing unto the LORD with the harp; with the harp, and the voice of a psalm.*
- 6 *With trumpets and sound of cornet make a joyful noise before the LORD, the King.*
- 7 *Let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.*
- 8 *Let the floods clap their hands: let the hills be joyful together*
- 9 *Before the LORD; for he cometh to judge the earth: with righteousness shall he judge the world, and the people with equity.*

2 · CONTEXT

A short, exuberant hymn of praise for a specific, recent act of salvation, likely military or national deliverance, that the psalmist treats as evidence of God's covenant faithfulness to Israel and, ultimately, of His coming righteous judgment over the whole earth. Henry notes how naturally the psalm moves from a particular deliverance to universal celebration—sea, floods, hills, and all peoples are drawn into the same joy—showing that specific answered prayer is meant to fuel, not exhaust, the scope of one's praise.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

The call to sing a new song rests on marvelous things God has done: His right hand and holy arm have gotten Him victory, He has made known His salvation openly before the nations, and remembered His mercy and truth toward the house of Israel—covenant faithfulness demonstrated in visible action.

Verse 4-6

Celebration widens into full sensory expression: make a joyful noise, sing praise, use harp, trumpets, and cornet, make a joyful noise before the Lord the King. Instruments and voice together are called for, holding nothing back in response to what God has done.

Verse 7-9

The invitation to praise expands to all creation: let the sea roar, the world and everyone in it, floods clap their hands, hills sing together for joy, because the Lord comes to judge the earth—to judge the world with righteousness and the people with equity. As in Psalm 96, judgment is treated as good news that all creation is pictured celebrating.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

A specific, recent experience of God's deliverance is meant to fuel expansive, whole-hearted praise rather than a quiet, private sigh of relief—voice, instrument, and even the natural world are drawn into the celebration. The same God who acts decisively in particular moments of salvation is the one whose coming judgment over the whole earth is cause for universal rejoicing, not dread.

Application for life today.

Identify a specific, recent 'marvelous thing' God has done in your life and let it prompt expansive praise rather than a quiet, private note of relief—sing it, speak it, mark it deliberately. Notice how this psalm refuses to separate personal deliverance from cosmic hope; let your own answered prayers deepen rather than narrow your confidence in God's larger purposes. Practice bringing your whole self—voice, gesture, even instruments—into worship rather than settling for a purely internal response.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific 'marvellous thing' has God recently done that deserves more expansive celebration than you have given it so far (vv. 1–3)?

2. How does this psalm's link between personal deliverance and universal, cosmic praise (vv. 7–9) reshape the scope of your own gratitude?

3. What would it look like to bring your whole self—voice, instrument, physical expression—into worship this week, rather than a purely private response (vv. 4–6)?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).